

Risk Register Report – Zimbabwe Bank Scenario

Operational Environment

A commercial bank located in Zimbabwe operates in an agro-ecological region with relatively low crime rates. The bank has:

- 100 employees working at the main branch offices
- 20 employees working remotely
- 2,000 individual customer accounts
- 200 commercial business accounts

The bank partners with a professional sports team and several local businesses to market its services. Because the bank handles sensitive financial information and customer funds, it must follow strict financial regulations and cybersecurity requirements. The bank must also maintain enough cash reserves daily to meet central banking regulations.

Although the physical crime rate is low, the bank still faces several risks related to cybercrime, human error, insider threats, and natural disasters such as storms and flooding that may affect operations.

Risk Register

Asset	Risk	Description	Likelihood (1–3)	Severity (1–3)	Priority Score
Funds	Business Email Compromise	An employee is tricked by a fake email into sharing confidential banking information or transferring funds to criminals.	3	2	6
Customer Database	Compromised User Database	Customer information is not strongly encrypted, allowing hackers to access sensitive data.	2	3	6
Financial Records	Financial Records Leak	Backup database servers are incorrectly	2	3	6

Asset	Risk	Description	Likelihood (1–3)	Severity (1–3)	Priority Score
		configured and publicly accessible online.			
Physical Cash & Assets	Theft	The bank safe or secure storage area is accidentally left unlocked by staff.	1	3	3
Banking Operations	Supply Chain Disruption	Flooding or transport delays prevent delivery of cash, equipment, or essential banking services.	2	2	4

Explanation of Risks

1. Business Email Compromise (BEC)

Scenario

A bank employee in Zimbabwe receives an email pretending to come from senior management or a trusted supplier. The employee unknowingly shares login details or authorizes a fake payment.

Impact

- Loss of company funds
- Exposure of confidential customer information
- Damage to the bank's reputation

Why the Risk Is High

The bank has many employees handling sensitive information, including remote workers who may be more vulnerable to phishing attacks.

Priority Score

Likelihood (3) × Severity (2) = **6**

2. Compromised User Database

Scenario

Hackers gain access to poorly encrypted customer records containing names, account details, and personal information.

Impact

- Identity theft
- Financial fraud
- Regulatory penalties
- Loss of customer trust

Why the Risk Is Serious

Banks store highly sensitive financial data, making them attractive targets for cybercriminals.

Priority Score

Likelihood (2) × Severity (3) = **6**

3. Financial Records Leak

Scenario

The bank's backup server is accidentally left accessible on the internet without proper security settings.

Impact

- Exposure of confidential financial records
- Legal and regulatory violations
- Financial penalties and lawsuits

Why the Risk Matters

Banks in Zimbabwe must comply with strict financial regulations to protect customer and business information.

Priority Score

Likelihood (2) × Severity (3) = **6**

4. Theft

Scenario

An employee forgets to lock the bank's safe or secure storage room at the end of the day.

Impact

- Theft of cash or important documents
- Financial losses
- Internal investigations

Why the Risk Is Lower

The area has low physical crime rates and security systems are already in place, reducing the likelihood.

Priority Score

Likelihood (1) × Severity (3) = **3**

5. Supply Chain Disruption

Scenario

Heavy rains, flooding, or fuel shortages in Zimbabwe delay the transportation of cash deliveries, ATM servicing, or important banking equipment.

Impact

- Delays in customer transactions
- Reduced banking operations
- Difficulty meeting cash reserve requirements

Why the Risk Exists

Environmental conditions and infrastructure challenges can affect transport and logistics.

Priority Score

Likelihood (2) × Severity (2) = **4**

Overall Risk Summary

The bank faces both cybersecurity and operational risks. The most critical threats involve cyberattacks such as business email compromise, database breaches, and financial data leaks. These risks are increased because many employees access sensitive systems daily, including remote workers.

Environmental and operational risks also exist due to Zimbabwe's infrastructure and weather-related disruptions. Although physical theft is less likely, it can still cause serious financial damage if security procedures are ignored.

To reduce these risks, the bank should:

- Enforce strong password policies
- Use multifactor authentication (MFA)
- Encrypt customer databases
- Configure firewalls correctly
- Train employees on phishing awareness
- Regularly audit backup servers and security systems
- Develop disaster recovery and business continuity plans

Conclusion

This risk register helps identify and prioritize threats facing the Zimbabwean bank. By understanding the likelihood and severity of each risk, management can focus on implementing stronger cybersecurity controls and operational safeguards. Regular monitoring and staff training will help protect customer information, maintain trust, and ensure compliance with financial regulations.